



and watch a sitcom or order a movie on demand.

This whole-hearted embrace of technology in our everyday life has come in for severe criticism. Psychologists glower at the way workplace connectivity eats up professional and personal time. They lecture against gifting leisure time to master new gizmos and electronic appliances.

Entertainment becomes an addiction when it becomes too high a priority. When you seek to be entertained all the time, don't go anywhere without an MP3 player and PDA, and prefer surfing the Internet and watching TV to interacting with your family, it becomes a disorder. The sad thing is that we let media come into our homes and watch what we would never dream of teaching our kids as acceptable, whether it's violence, teen sex or disrespect for elders.

The downside. A few disadvan-

tages of the electronic life are:

1. Hours at the computer leaves no time for socialising or volunteering for community work.

2. Physical activities that give an endorphin rush and a feeling of well-being become limited.

3. Watching violent television programmes or video games can make children aggressive.

4. Constant use of electronic gadgets is said to be reshaping our brains and making our thinking shallower.

Word of advice

So there is a need to enjoy electronic entertainment with a fine balance. Any technology-based activity shouldn't leave us vulnerable. Master the technology and learn to use it in a healthy and positive way. ●

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